Sign	0	1	2
Appearance	Blue, pale	Body pink Limbs blue	All pink
Pulse (heart rate)	Absent	<100	>100
Grimace (response to stimuli)	None	Grimace	cry
Activity (muscle tone)	Limp	Some flexion of limbs	Active movements
Respiratory effort	None	Slow irregular	Good strong cry



Total score – 10

No depression – 7-10

Mild 4-7

Severe 1-4

The scores are added and the total score is documented. Babies scoring above seven rarely need resuscitation. The APGAR score which is undertaken to determine how well the baby is adjusting from intrauterine to extra uterine life.

9. **Vital Signs:**

Axiliary temperature 36.5° C – 37.6° C

Heart rate 120 – 140/minute

Respiration 40-60 /minute

10. **Grasp reflex :**

Mature newborn's grasp is strong.



What reflexes should be present in an infant?

1. Rooting reflex – The reflex begins when the corner of the baby's mouth is touched.
2. Sucking reflex – Helps the baby become ready to suck.
3. Moro reflex – It is often called as startle reflex.
4. Tonic neck reflex – Also known as fencing reflex.
5. Grasp reflex – When an object is placed in an infant's hand and the palm of the child is stroked. The fingers will close reflexively.
6. Stepping reflex – when the soles of their feet touch a flat surface, they will attempt to walk by placing one foot infront of another.

6.4 NURSING CARE OF HEALTHY NEONATES

The first week of life is the most critical period in the life of an infant. The expert obstetric care is scarce and the home environment conditions in which baby is born are usually unsatisfactory.

XII_Nursing_Vocational_Unit 6.indd 186 1/11/2020 2:50:44 PM